Marketing plan of business

Definition :

"A marketing plan is a strategic roadmap that businesses use to organize, execute, and track their marketing strategy over a given period. Marketing plans can include different marketing strategies for various marketing teams across the company, all working toward the same business goals."

Components of a marketing plan

1.Executive summary

The executive summary explains the overall purpose of your marketing plan and briefly describes all the relevant components. It includes an overview of your marketing and advertising goals, a description of your current marketing position, an overview of your campaign's timeline, and a description of your product/service and target market.

2.Mission statement

A mission statement is a short statement reflecting the purpose of your business at that point in time. It can talk about what you do, the types of products and services you offer, your target market, or your competitive advantage.

3.Market analysis

A market analysis asks you to look deeply at your business and industry. For this section, you will reflect on where your business and your marketing strategy stand right now. You should include what you're selling, your unique selling proposition (what separates you from competitors), your best performing marketing channels and campaigns so far, and your current marketing objectives.

4. SWOT analysis

A SWOT analysis looks at the internal and external environment your business operates in.

- Strengths refer to what your business does well, your tangible assets and internal resources, and what sets you apart from the competition.
- Weaknesses include areas where your business needs to improve, resource limitations, and places where your competitors are excelling.
- Opportunities refer to your industry as a whole, including underserved markets, lack of competitors, growing popularity for the products/services you provide, and positive media coverage of your industry.
- Threats include parts of the external environment that could potentially harm your business, like new laws and regulations, negative media coverage, decline of your industry, and emerging competitors.

05 .Competitor analysis

If you offer a similar product or service to other companies, you need to communicate why your offering is more valuable. To do so, you must understand what your competitors are selling, who their audience is, and how they're communicating with that audience. The best place to start is your competitors' website and social media accounts. Buy their products, sign up for their newsletter, or attend one of their events. Read their customer reviews and media coverage to learn more about their successes and failures.

6. Target market and buyer personas

Your target market represents the ideal customers of your product or service. You may have one ideal customer, or you may market to a few different personas. When thinking about your target market, consider these attributes:

- Demographics – age, gender, income, education, occupation, marital States
- Geographics – location (country, region, state, city, town), climate, culture
- Psychographics – lifestyle, attitudes, risk tolerance, aspirations, personality, values, struggles, pain points, goals

- Behavioral attributes – preferred channels and content types, loyalty, frequency of purchases, affiliations

7.Marketing objectives and KPIs

Your objectives are the goals of your campaign, or what you hope to accomplish. Your KPIs, or key performance indicators, are the metrics you will track to determine if you met your objectives. It's also important to track how your KPIs change over time. Here are some example KPIs to track based on your campaign:

- Social media – followers, engagement rate, mentions, reach, ROAS
- Content – comments, shares, downloads, conversion rate, leads, search ranking
- Website – organic traffic, paid traffic, keyword rankings, session duration, bounce rate, conversion rate, CPA
- App – weekly active users, activation rate, conversion rate, churn rate, CLTV.

8. Pricing strategy

You need to consider how you will price your products and services. There are many types of pricing strategies, but these are the main three:

- **Price skimming** – price above competitors to recapture your margins, and lower the price as time passes. With this strategy, you will likely sell fewer products at a higher price point.
- **Competitive pricing –** base your pricing off of what competitors are charging
- **Penetration pricing** – price below competitors to increase market share, gain customers, and sell more units. With this strategy, you try to sell a large volume at a lower price point and then raise prices as time passes

9.Marketing channels

Consider the best channels to promote your business on. You may even decide to create a separate social media and/or content marketing strategy within your overall marketing plan, including your editorial calendar, content types and topics, and the channels you'll be posting on. When choosing marketing channels, think about where your target audience spends their time and what type of information they engage with. You also need to decide whether to use free channels, paid channels, or a combination of both. Here are some examples of popular channels:

- Social media – Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, LinkedIn, Twitter, Reddit, Telegram, Pinterest, TikTok, Clubhouse
- Content marketing – blogs, infographics, tutorials, guides, case studies, newsletters, webinars, demos, events, presentations, guest blogs, whitepapers, podcasts
- Communities – Industry specific websites, forums, and social media groups
- Media coverage – press, features in other websites and publications, partnerships, tags or mentions on social media

10. Growth strategy

Growth strategy refers to your long term plans and goals. Think about where you want your business to be in six months, a year, or even five years. How does this individual campaign or plan fit in with your overall marketing or business strategy? If your plan is successful, what project will you take on next? If your plan is unsuccessful, will you move on or try a different approach?

11. Budgeting

In order to actually execute your marketing plan, you will need a realistic budget. Your goal is to execute your plan in an affordable and cost-effective way. In other words, you should be seeing more returns, sales, or benefits than what you're spending. There are many free budgeting templates online you can use to track your expenses. However you decide to create a budget, it's important to build in a little flexibility for unexpected changes in your plan.